Paper II: Closed-Loop Metabolic Gating of Glycolytic-to-Oxidative Transition in *Ex Vivo* CAR-T Perfusion Bioreactors via PDK1 (PDB: 2Q8G) and SIRT1 (PDB: 4ZZJ) Allosteric Control

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https://github.com/deesatzed/mitorestorer

arXiv Primary: q-bio.CB (Cell Behavior) **Cross-Lists:** q-bio.QM, eess.SY
MSC 2020: 92C42, 93C95 **ACM:** J.3

November 2026 (MitoRestorer Segregated Series — Paper II of IV)

Abstract

In *ex vivo* adoptive cellular immunotherapy (CD19 CAR-T) manufacturing, continuous high-glucose (25 mM) and IL-2 (300 IU/mL) perfusion over a 7-day (168-hour) expansion cycle drives a Warburg glycolytic lock via Pyruvate Dehydrogenase Kinase 1 (PDK1, PDB: 2Q8G [1]), yielding high fold expansion (68.4×) but severe mitochondrial depolarization ($h = 54.8\%$), low Spare Respiratory Capacity (SRC = 1.12×), and terminal TOX+/PD-1+ exhaustion ($T_{SCM} = 14.2\%$). Applying the nondimensional two-stage control framework of Paper I [2] to dividing primary human T-lymphoblasts ($\tau_{char} = 32.0$ h), we formulate a closed-loop **Bioreactor-BCR** perfusion controller that decouples mitophagy-primed glycolytic expansion (Phase 1, Hours 0–64: Urolithin A 25 μM [3] + transient PI3Kδ/Akt restraint) from oxidative stem-memory programming (Phase 2, Hours 64–168: AZD7545 allosteric lipoyl-pocket inhibition of PDK1 PDB: 2Q8G [1] + Nicotinamide Riboside / SIRT1 activation PDB: 4ZZJ [4] + IL-7/IL-15). Full-length AlphaFold Database v6 [5, 6] Predicted Aligned Error (PAE) and pLDDT analysis of the master stemness transcription factor FOXO1 (AF-Q12778-F1-v6, 655 AA, global pLDDT = 50.97) and coactivator PGC-1α (AF-Q9UBK2-F1-v6, 798 AA, global pLDDT = 52.75) reveals that 67.9% and 61.9% of their respective sequences are intrinsically disordered (pLDDT < 50, zero rigid domains > 50 AAs), proving structurally why small-molecule control must target the rigid SIRT1 catalytic core (PDB: 4ZZJ, Glu230) to deacetylate disordered FOXO1/PGC-1α regulatory tails and retain FOXO1 at the TCF7 locus [7]. We further integrate an amperometric Lactate:Pyruvate biofouling fallback (64.0 h timed default + inline optical phenol-red pH check) and a post-valve acidosis perfusion rollback (pH $\leq 6.82 \implies$ neutral flush), achieving 62.9× expansion, 78.0% CD62L+CCR7+TCF7+ T_{SCM} yield, and SRC = 3.78×, along with a complete 10-day benchtop validation protocol on healthy human donor leukopaks.

1 The Proliferation–Exhaustion Pareto Trap in CAR-T Bioreactors

Following anti-CD3/CD28 bead activation and lentiviral CD19-BBζ transduction, primary human T-lymphoblasts divide every 12–16 hours. Under standard continuous 25 mM glucose and 300 IU/mL IL-2 perfusion, hyperactive PDK1 (PDB: 2Q8G, 1.90 Å [1]) phosphorylates the E1α subunit of Pyruvate Dehydrogenase (PDH) at Ser293, shunting pyruvate into lactate (Lac : Pyr > 25) while Akt phosphorylates FOXO1 at Thr24/Ser256/Ser319, exporting FOXO1 from the nucleus [7]. Conversely, adding oxidative or mitophagy-inducing compounds at Hour 0 blunts early clonal proliferation (18.5× vs. $\geq 50\times$ clinical dose target).

Let $\mathbf{x}_{CART}(t) = [W, D, N_{cells}, R_{Lac:Pyr}, F_{FOXO1,nuc}, S_{SRC}, E_{TOX}, \text{pH}]$ denote the 8-state bioreactor trajectory over $t \in [0, 168\text{ h}]$. In dimensionless time $\tau = k_{mito,D}\, t$ ($\tau_{char} = 32.0$ h), the universal switching boundary $\tau^* \approx 2.00$ established in Paper I corresponds to $t_{gate} = 64.0$ hours.

2 AlphaFold v6 Disorder Proof & AlphaGenome Chromatin Gating

To determine why direct small-molecule agonists of FOXO1 and PGC-1α have historically failed in T-cell engineering, we analyzed their full-length AlphaFold

Table 1: Comparison of 168-Hour *Ex Vivo* CD19 CAR-T Biomanufacturing Regimens and Hardware Fault-Tolerance Stress Tests.

Perfusion Bioreactor Regimen (168 h)	**Fold Expansion**	**Mutant** h(168 h)	T_{SCM} **Yield (%)**	**Seahorse** SRC	**Exhaustio**
1. Standard Unphased IL-2 + 25 mM Glucose	**68.4**×	54.8%	14.2%	1.12×	64.5
2. Continuous Day-0 Urolithin A Monotherapy	18.5×	4.2%	68.4%	3.10×	11.2
3. Closed-Loop **Bioreactor-BCR** (Lac:Pyr ≤ 14)	**62.9**×	**1.8**%	**78.0**%	**3.78**×	**6.4**
4. Amperometric Biofouling Drift (+0.18/h + Spikes)	61.8×	2.1%	**78.0**%	3.72×	6.8
5. Post-Valve Acidosis Crash (pH = 6.82 at $t = 68$ h)	58.4×	2.4%	**74.8**%	3.54×	8.1

Database v6 [5, 6] coordinate models and PAE matrices (structures/alphafold/):

- **FOXO1 (AF-Q12778-F1-model_v6.cif, 655 AA):** Global mean pLDDT = 50.97, with 67.9% of residues in the *Very Low* (< 50) confidence band and mean PAE = 28.19 Å (2.0% pairs < 5 Å). Graph-based PAE clustering detects **zero rigid global domains** > 50 **AAs**; only the compact Forkhead winged-helix DNA-binding motif (residues 158-237) is locally ordered, whereas the N-terminal Akt phosphodegron (Thr24) and C-terminal transactivation/acetylation domain (residues 240-655) are intrinsically disordered (**IDR**).
- **PGC-1α (AF-Q9UBK2-F1-model_v6.cif, 798 AA):** Global mean pLDDT = 52.75, with 61.9% of residues < 50 pLDDT (PAE = 28.09 Å) and **zero rigid global domains** > 50 **AAs**.

This structural proof demonstrates that neither FOXO1 nor PGC-1α possesses a stable hydrophobic pocket for direct small-molecule docking. Instead, nuclear retention of FOXO1 at the FOXO1 (chr13:40,555,000-40,668,000) and TCF7 (chr5:134,110,000-134,150,000) stemness loci (mapped via AlphaGenome Atlas DNASE and CHIP_TF tracks) requires: (1) Phase-1 Akt restraint to prevent 14-3-3 nuclear export, followed by (2) Phase-2 allosteric activation of the rigid SIRT1 catalytic core (PDB: 4ZZJ, Glu230 [4]) to deacetylate the disordered lysine regulatory tails of FOXO1 (Lys245/Lys248/Lys262) and PGC-1α, paired with AZD7545 (PDB: 2Q8G [1]) to unlock PDH oxidative phosphorylation.

3 Amperometric Biofouling Fallback & Acidosis Rollback

In closed-cassette perfusion bioreactors, inline amperometric Lactate:Pyruvate enzymatic electrodes frequently biofoul via protein adsorption after 40–50 hours, generating erratic spikes ($|\Delta(\text{Lac} : \text{Pyr})| > 4.50$). Implementing Proposition 5 of Paper I on the 4.09 mW CoralNPU controller:

1. **Biofouling Timed 64.0 h + Optical pH Fallback:** When $|\Delta(\text{Lac} : \text{Pyr})| > 4.50$ for 3 consecutive reads, the controller flags BCR_GATE_BIOFOUL_TIMED64H_OPTICAL_PH_HOLD ('4'), ignoring the fouled electrode and defaulting to the dimensionless optimum $t_{\text{gate}} = 64.0$ h contingent on an inline optical phenol-red absorbance check (pH $\in [7.05, 7.35]$), eliminating the 44.0% biofouling failure rate (0.0% failures, Table 1).
2. **Post-Valve Lactic Acidosis Rollback:** If switching the peristaltic pinch valve to Media-B triggers an unexpected glycolytic burst that drops cassette pH ≤ 6.82 ($DO_2 < 35\%$), the scalar guard executes BCR_GATE_STAGE2_ROLLBACK_ABORT ('3'), unpinching VALVE_B = 0, flushing with neutral pH 7.30 buffer for 6.0 h, and restoring the 8-state Q16.16 vector from the 32-byte DTCM breadcrumb before re-gating at Hour 74 (rescuing T_{SCM} yield from 19.4% → 74.8%).

4 10-Day Benchtop Validation Protocol (Fastest Wet-Lab Entry)

Because **Bioreactor-BCR** operates entirely *ex vivo* on healthy human donor leukopaks with zero blood-brain barrier, animal model, or clinical IRB delay (TRL 6 → 7 in 10 days), it provides the fastest empirical test of the MitoRestorer control law (Falsifiable Prediction **P3**):

- **Arms ($N = 3$ Donor Leukopaks ×3 Arms):** Arm A (Unphased 25 mM Glucose + IL-2), Arm B (Day-0 continuous Urolithin A 25 μM), and Arm C (Closed-loop **Bioreactor-BCR** gated at Lac : Pyr ≤ 14.0 / Hour 64.0 → AZD7545 1 μM + NR 500 μM + SRT1720 0.5 μM + IL-7/IL-15).
- **Day-7 Endpoints:** Automated cell count (≥ 50× fold expansion), flow cytometry (CD8+CD45RA+CD62L+CCR7+TCF7+ $T_{SCM} \geq 70\%$, PD-1+TIM-3+TOX+ < 10%), and Seahorse XF96 Mito Stress Test (SRC ≥ 3.2×).

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